



EduHub

USER RESEARCH REPORT

Empathize Phase — Design Thinking Project

Team Members:

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1. Executive Summary

EduHub is a student-to-student platform designed to solve a deeply felt pain point in Egyptian university life: the high cost of textbooks and study materials. Students frequently pay full price for books they use for only a single semester, then struggle to resell or exchange them through informal, unreliable channels such as Facebook groups and WhatsApp chats.

This report summarizes the user research conducted during the Empathize phase of our Design Thinking project. Through structured online surveys (Google Forms), and empathy mapping, we gathered insights from Egyptian university students to validate our idea and deeply understand their needs, behaviors, frustrations, and motivations.

Key findings confirm strong demand for a trusted, organized platform for book exchange coupled with AI-powered study tools — including book summarization, flashcards, practice quizzes, and mind maps — and a peer community for collaborative learning.

2. Project Idea

EduHub is an integrated web platform targeting university students, built around three core pillars:

- **Book & Tool Exchange Marketplace:** A trusted, verified platform where students can list, buy, sell, or donate used textbooks and study materials at fair prices, replacing chaotic social-media groups.
- **AI-Powered Study Tools:** Integrated artificial intelligence features to help students study more efficiently — including automatic book summarization, flashcard generation, practice question sets, mind map creation, and topic-based quizzes.
- **Student Community Hub:** A moderated discussion forum where students share study experiences, recommend resources, and support one another across courses and universities.

The platform addresses the intersection of financial stress, time pressure, and the lack of trustworthy peer-to-peer exchange infrastructure that Egyptian students face today.

3. Research Methodology

3.1 Research Objectives

- Understand students' current behaviors around sourcing and disposing of textbooks.
- Identify emotional and financial pain points related to academic resource access.
- Gauge interest in a dedicated exchange platform and AI study tools.
- Discover trust and usability concerns that must be addressed in the design.

3.2 Research Method

Method	Tool / Platform	Purpose
Online Survey	Google Forms (distributed via WhatsApp & university groups)	Broad quantitative data from a diverse student sample

Survey Link:

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSfYpTaM0qGlFDpaZT8dpNGhXIkM32myNTI6PS_JwteqiXMqyQ/viewform?usp=dialog

Excel Sheet Link:

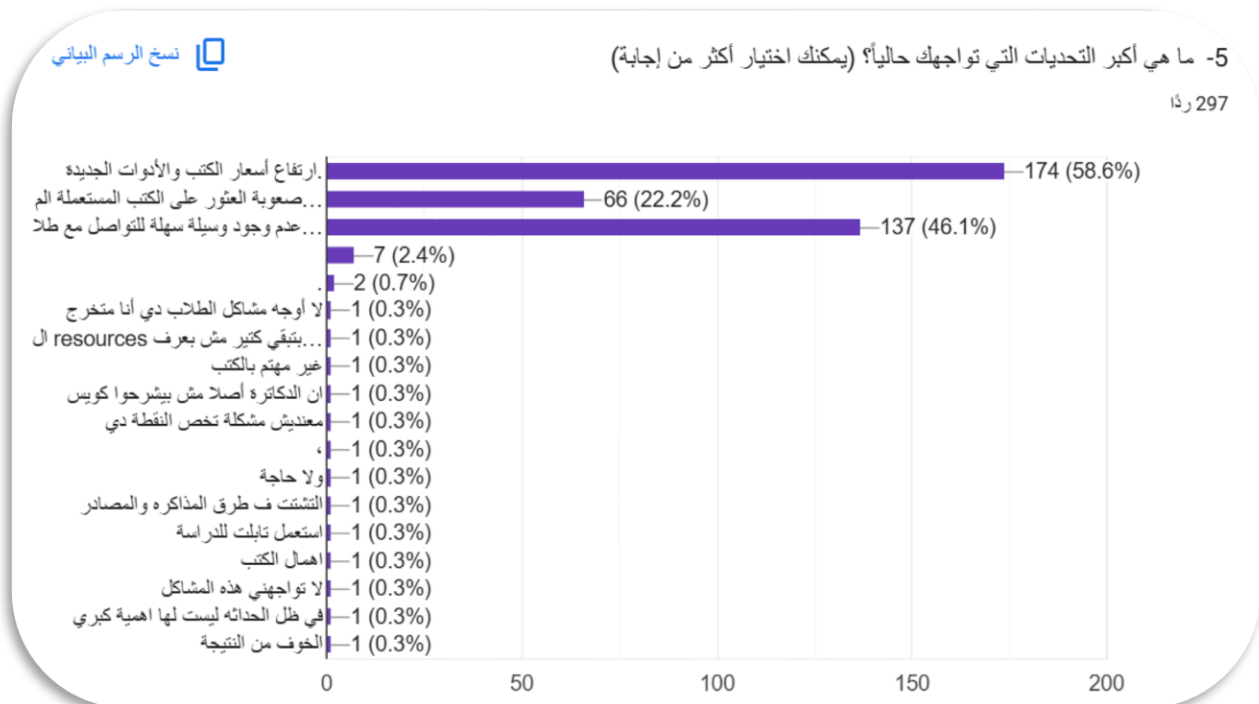
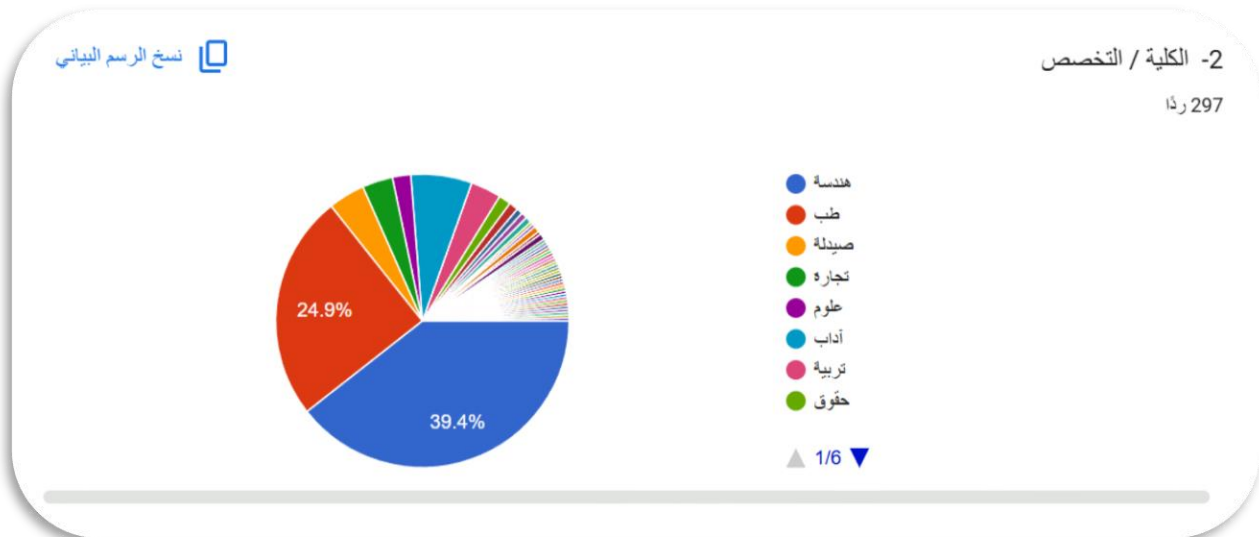
<https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1SjbsSJKAxbtg9zkCkP-33QIZAy-gv6Q4qLPF4eMWznm/edit?usp=sharing>

3.3 Sample Profile

- Target group: Egyptian university students (undergraduate and postgraduate)
- Age range: 18 to 26 years
- Survey distribution: WhatsApp university groups, Facebook student pages, and direct outreach
- Interview participants: Students from multiple faculties including Engineering, Medicine, Business, and Humanities

4. Key Survey Findings

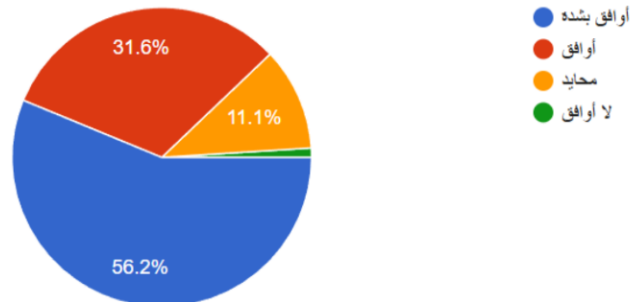
The following table summarizes the most significant findings from our Google Forms survey, which was distributed to students across multiple Egyptian universities.



نسخ الرسم البياني

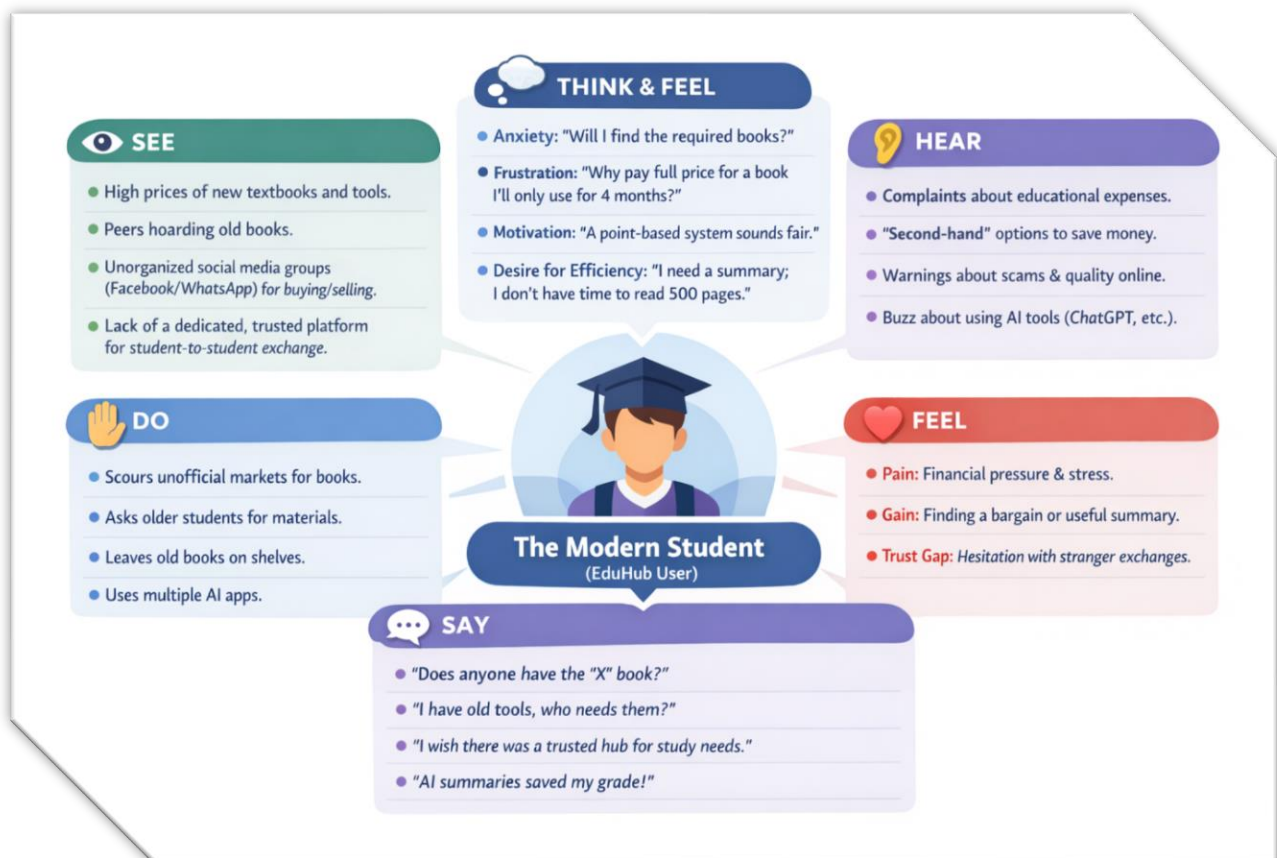
6- أحتاج إلى منصة موثوقة لتبادل الكتب والأدوات مع طلاب آخرين

297 ردًا



5. Empathy Map

The empathy map below was created based on direct interviews and survey responses. It captures the holistic experience of our primary user — The Modern Egyptian University Student — across six key dimensions.



6. User Personas

Based on our research synthesis, we identified four primary user archetypes. Each persona represents a distinct pattern of behaviors, needs, and goals that EduHub must serve.



EDUHUB USER & BOOK DONOR

Sarah Ali

"Sharing resources is how we all succeed. Eduhub helps me clear my shelves and find what I need."

ABOUT

Sarah is an undergraduate Psychology major, passionate about peer-to-peer learning. She has finished many of her core text requirements and wants to share her used books and find specialized summaries for her advanced courses. She is also a frequent user of the campus AI-lab and is excited about Eduhub's summarization features.

AGE	21
OCCUPATION	Psychology Student
INCOME	4,000 - 6,000 EGP per month
STATUS	Single
LOCATION	Cairo, Egypt

NEEDS

- Efficiently list used textbooks and materials for others.
- Easy system to find the exact used books she needs (e.g., search by ISBN).
- Access to high-quality book summaries for revision.
- Engage with other students about specific course content in the discussion forums.

FRUSTRATIONS

- Difficulty finding other students to buy/trade books with at reasonable prices.
- Feeling overwhelmed with a full course load and looking for streamlined study tools.
- Worried about the quality of some crowd-sourced summaries.
- Hesitation with the Eduhub point system or secure cash exchange.

SOCIAL MEDIA ACTIVITY

FACEBOOK	
INSTAGRAM	
TWITTER	
SNAPCHAT	

CURRENT FEELINGS

Overwhelmed, Stressed (but focused)
Optimistic

PERSONALITY

STUDIOUS	HELPFUL	DRIVEN
COLLABORATIVE	ORGANIZED	

7. Reason for selecting this idea

Egyptian university students need an affordable, trusted way to access, exchange, and efficiently study from academic materials — but currently lack a unified platform that addresses both financial constraints and study efficiency simultaneously.